



WHEN YOU'VE BEEN HOLDING TOO MUCH FOR TOO LONG

A Gentle Reflection Guide
for When
Life Feels Heavy

Created by Awaken Discovery

WELCOME

Sometimes we become so used to carrying things that we stop noticing the weight of it all, and sometimes even what got us here.

We keep going.

We keep functioning.

We keep showing up.

We keep putting others first.

We keep, we keep.....

We tell ourselves:

"I just need to get through this week."

"Other people have it worse."

"I don't have time to fall apart."

"I need to stay strong."

Over time, these messages can become so familiar that we stop questioning them.

Yet underneath the coping, there may be exhaustion.

Not because you're failing.

Because you've been holding too much for too long.

This guide offers a gentle space to pause, reflect, and reconnect with yourself.

You do not need to fix everything today.

You only need to begin noticing what you have been carrying.

One small step at a time.

YOU'VE BEEN CARRYING MORE THAN PEOPLE CAN SEE.

Not everything we carry is visible.

Some burdens are practical.

Some are emotional.

Some come from responsibility, expectation, loss, uncertainty, or simply trying to hold life together.

Often, others only see the parts of us that continue to cope.

They don't always see the effort that goes into it behind the scenes.

Take a moment to consider what has been sitting on your shoulders recently.

Reflection

What have you been carrying recently that others may not fully see?

What impact is carrying these things having on you?

CHECKING IN WITH YOURSELF

When we have been carrying too much for too long, we often lose connection with ourselves.

Take a moment to gently check in.

What thoughts keep returning?

Where are you holding tension, stress, or exhaustion?

What emotions need acknowledging today?

Beyond the pressure, expectations, and noise, what feels true for you right now?

WHAT DO YOU NEED PERMISSION TO STOP HOLDING?

Sometimes healing begins not with doing more, but with loosening our grip.

Imagine for a moment that you did not need to carry everything today.

Not forever.

Just today.

What would you put down?

Complete the sentences:

I give myself permission to...

I do not need to...

It is okay if...

Today I choose to...

COMING HOME TO THIS MOMENT

When we have been carrying too much, our minds often live somewhere else.

The future says: "What if?"

The past says: "I should have done it differently?"

The present simply says: (If we remembered to listen) it would probably look for "What is here right now?"

Take a slow breath.

Notice:

What you can see

.....

.....

What you can feel

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.....

What you can hear

.....

.....

What you can smell

.....

.....

What you need right now

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.....

*You do not need to solve everything today.
You only need to meet yourself where you are.*

A LETTER TO YOURSELF

Imagine speaking to yourself as you would speak to someone you care deeply about.

What would you want them to know?

What would you want them to stop carrying alone?

Dear Me,

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

BEFORE YOU GO

If this guide resonated with you, it may be a sign that you've been carrying more than you realised.

Awareness is often the first step.

The next step is understanding the patterns beneath the overwhelm, reconnecting with your emotions, and finding your way back to yourself.

Finding Calm

A Journal for Understanding Anxiety and Finding Your Way Back to Yourself

This guided journal will help you:

- ✨ Understand what you're carrying
- ✨ Recognise patterns in your thoughts and emotions
- ✨ Develop self-awareness and self-compassion
- ✨ Create your own calm and grounding practices
- ✨ Begin reconnecting with yourself one step at a time

Because sometimes healing begins when we stop trying to hold everything alone.

About Awaken Discovery

Awaken Discovery was created to support people in reconnecting with themselves during times of stress, anxiety, overwhelm, uncertainty, and emotional challenge.

Through counselling, wellbeing resources, workshops, and reflective tools, our aim is to offer gentle support that helps you understand yourself more deeply and find your way back to what matters most.

Helping you reconnect with yourself.

✨ One small step at a time.

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If you are experiencing significant emotional distress or require immediate support, please seek assistance from an appropriate healthcare professional or emergency service.